

It sold a total of 24 million devices worldwide and strongly maintained its 2nd position right behind PlayStation all throughout. It also gave Microsoft a thumbs up that they were moving on the right path and their next generation console was going to be even better.

Sony PlayStation 2

Successor to the highly successful PlayStation, the PlayStation 2 went on to become an even bigger hit. More than 150 million devices were sold until 2011 and the device was finally discontinued in 2013, long after the launch of the next generation of consoles also. The device had a number of nifty features like backward compatibility with the previous generation device, capability to play audio CDs and DVD movies and also was compatible with the PlayStation memory card and controllers.

Sony worked on something called the 'emotion engine CPU' for its second console. The chip had impressive specifications and was capable of performing at 6.2 GFLOPS. Paired with its GPU, the console could render more than 75 million polygons per second standalone and a real world performance of 3 to 16 million polygons per second accounting for other things like lighting, texture mapping, AI and game physics. PlayStation 2 came with an improved version of the highly acclaimed DualShock controller of its previous generation called the DualShock 2. The addition of 4 extra buttons in the DualShock controller had proved to be a smart decision with the launch of game titles like Devil May Cry, God of War and Grand Theft Auto, which were more free world oriented and provided the players with more options and capabilities.

Overall, the Sony PlayStation 2 was a huge success breaking many records including selling 100 million devices in under 6 years.

Nintendo GameCube

Codenamed Dolphin, the GameCube was the 6th generation offering from Nintendo. It came with optical disk drive support and also supported online gaming for a couple of its popular titles by using a broadband or modem adapter. The quirky looking console, was relatively inexpensive but lacked enough game titles. More than 22 million devices were sold worldwide but the device never caught the fancy of the mass the way it intended to do. It ranked a measly 3rd in an underwhelming battle of only 3 competitors - itself, Sony and Microsoft